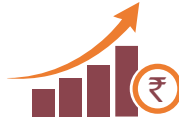


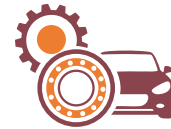
WHAT MAKES SCHAEFFLER TICK



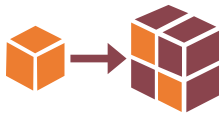
Though present in India since 1962, the Schaeffler brand was formally unified here in 2018



It has invested ₹5,000 crore in India over the last five years, and has earmarked a similar amount for the next five years



Schaeffler is among the top two brands in both the core segments where it operates—auto components and industrial bearings



It is now transitioning from providing only components to entire modules



Exports have largely been driven by internal demand from other geographies



It also operates in the after-sales market, giving it an edge over rivals

expansion of conventional and electrified powertrain technologies.

Alongside, the engineering centres contribute to long-term programmes for the group. “While we are strengthening localisation across design and manufacturing, Schaeffler in India is also serving global needs,” says Madhurisha Vippatoori, Vice President (R&D) & CTO, Schaeffler India.

Analysts point out that the company has been growing consistently over the past few years aided by strong support from the parent entity. “Europe is ahead of India when it comes to adopting newer transmission systems. When Indian OEMs want to launch a new product, it’s easier for Schaeffler to import the core technology and adapt it locally, leading to a much faster time to

market,” says an analyst.

“The company’s portfolio gives it an advantage as it operates at the premium end and has higher profitability and ROCE compared to most of its competitors,” says Devan Choksey, Managing Director of DRChoksey Finserv.

Kadam says there is a clear commitment on investments, including intellectual capabilities. And there is also a clear focus on transfer of technology and knowledge. For instance, while ICE technology is being phased out in Europe, demand remains robust in India. So, the company is moving certain production lines from Europe to India.

INDIA FOCUS

Kadam says the past few years have been about creating a solid found-

dation in India, aided in part by acquisitions that helped fill certain capability gaps.

In 2023, it acquired Koovers (KRSV Innovative Auto Solutions), a Bengaluru-based business-to-business e-commerce platform, to enter the digital automotive after-market space. Last year, it bought Pune-based Dhruva Automation & Controls (now Schaeffler Digital), an engineering and service provider specialising in smart industrial automation and software solutions in the Asia Pacific region. It also acquired the Indian operations of the Vitesco Group, which operates in the power electronics segment. This was a global acquisition done by the parent company.

“Today, we are in a much stronger position to go to the customer